



YSR INAUGURATING THE JALAYAGNAM SCHEME AT HIMAYAT SAGAR IN 2005

Thin is In

Some of the schemes that have been put on the backburner



Jalayagnam from Rs **18,000 cr** in 2009-10 to Rs **15,000 cr** in 2010-2011



Power subsidy from Rs **6,040 cr** to Rs **4,500 cr**



Food subsidy from Rs **3,500 cr** to Rs **3,000 cr**



Housing from Rs **5,000 cr** to Rs **1,800 cr**

beneficiaries during the current fifth phase of the land distribution scheme.

A finance minister for long, Rosaiah is acutely conscious about holding on to the purse strings and spending wisely from the state's kitty. The state's revenues grew at a rate of over 19 per cent a year during 2004-08 but fell to 10 per cent in 2008-09. It's grimmer now, with revenue growth falling further to 5 per cent between April and December 2009. Despite Rosaiah's assertions, there are cutbacks of different kinds to ensure that only the targeted benefit from the welfare schemes. It is distinct from the lenient "saturation concept", implemented on the insistence of YSR by which all families below the poverty line were to be helped through at least two state-initiated poverty alleviation measures, including the food subsidy. But the lack of adequate input control, as pointed out in the latest report of the Comptroller and Auditor

General (CAG) of India for the year ending March 31, 2009, resulted in disbursement of Rs 479.55 crore to multiple beneficiaries under one ration card and another Rs 4.15 crore to the same beneficiaries under multiple IDs (*see Thin is In*).

The Chief Minister is steadily shifting from the "saturation concept" since he assumed office. His concern is to avoid duplication, wastage and undeserved claims by those who are ineligible for the anti-poverty

LIKE HIS FATHER, JAGANMOHAN REMAINS A POPULAR DRAW BUT AFTER MONTHS OF DITHERING, ROSAIAH IS FINALLY GETTING HIS ACT TOGETHER.

sops as well as the criticism by fund-givers like the Planning Commission and watchdog agencies on the dilution of welfare programmes and wrongful targeting of public funds. He is trying to do this without disrespecting the YSR mantra of people's welfare. For a start, Rosaiah has followed the move initiated by YSR to vigorously weed out bogus and other fraudulent claims of food subsidy and at the same time called for prudent norms. The survey to weed out bogus and duplicate BPL ration cards is to be completed by April-end. The Government is also planning to introduce a biometric system for ration card holders to prevent misuse of the public distribution system.

Free power to farmers and augmenting irrigation facilities and reach through Jalayagnam, which remained the prime focus areas of YSR, continues to be in the limelight. But, as the state is strapped for cash, Rosaiah has warned of the need for